

Cartesian product:

The Cartesian product of two sets A and B denoted by $A \times B$ is the set of all ordered pairs of the form (a, b) where $a \in A$, $b \in B$.

$$A \times B = \{ (a, b) \mid a \in A, b \in B \}$$

Ex:

① If $A = \{1, 2\}$, $B = \{x\}$

then $A \times B = \{ (1, x), (2, x) \}$

② If $A = \{a, b, c\}$, $B = \{1, 2\}$

then $A \times B = \{ (a, 1), (a, 2), (b, 1), (b, 2), (c, 1), (c, 2) \}$

$$B \times A = \{(1, a), (1, b), (1, c), (2, a), (2, b), (2, c)\}$$

Note: $A \times B \neq B \times A$ -

Binary relation:

When A and B are sets, a subset R of the Cartesian product $A \times B$ is called a binary relation from A to B .

If R is a binary relation from A to B and if $(a, b) \in R$, where $a \in A$ and $b \in B$ then we

Say that 'a' is related to 'b'
and is written as aRb .

If $(a, b) \notin R$ it is denoted by $a \not R b$.

Note:

Mostly we will deal with
relationships between the elements
of two sets, Hence the word
'binary' will be omitted hereafter.

If R is a subset of $A \times A$
then R is called a relation on
the set A .

The set $\{a \in A / a R b, \text{ for some } b \in B\}$ is called the domain of R and denoted by $D(R)$.

The set $\{b \in B / a R b, \text{ for some } a \in A\}$ is called the range of R denoted by $R(R)$.

Ex:

①

Let $A = \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4\}$

$B = \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$ and $a R b$ if

$$a + b = 4.$$

Then $R = \{(1, 3), (2, 2), (3, 1), (4, 0)\}$

The domain of $R = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$
& the range of $R = \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$

② Let R be the relation on
 $A = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ defined by
 aRb if $a \leq b$, $a, b \in A$.

Then $R = \{(1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), (1, 4),$
 $(2, 2), (2, 3), (2, 4), (3, 3), (3, 4),$
 $(4, 4)\}$

The domain & range of R
are both equal to A .

Properties of Relations:

Let A be a set and R be a relation on A .

Then R is called

- (i) Reflexive if for all $a \in A$, aRa
- (ii) Symmetric if aRb holds $\Rightarrow$
 bRa must be hold, for $a, b \in A$

(iii) Anti symmetric, if $a R b$ and $b R a$ hold then $a = b$.

(iv) Transitive, if $a R b$ and $b R c$ hold $\Rightarrow a R c$ must be hold, for $a, b, c \in A$.

(v) R is not reflexive, if $(a, a) \notin R$
(irreflexive)
for at least $a \in A$

(vi) R is not Symmetric if $(a, b) \in R$
but $(b, a) \notin R$
for at least one pair $(a, b) \in R$.

(vii) R is not transitive if $(a, b) \in R$,
 $(b, c) \in R$ but
 $(a, c) \notin R$ if
 $a, b, c \in A$.

(viii) R is not anti symmetric, $\neg \forall a R b$
and $b R a$ but $a \neq b$

Note:

If a relation which is not symmetric, it is not necessarily anti symmetric.

Ex:

Let R is a relation on $A = \{1, 2, 3\}$ defined by $(a, b) \in R$ if $a \leq b$ where $a, b \in A$, then

$$R = \{ (1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 2), (2, 3), (3, 3) \}$$

R is reflexive, since each of the elements of A is related to itself, as $(1,1)$, $(2,2)$ and $(3,3)$ are members in R .

If R is a relation on $A = \{1, 2, 3\}$ defined by $(a, b) \in R$ if $a < b$, where $a, b \in A$, then

$$R = \{(1, 2), (2, 3), (1, 3)\}$$

Here R is not reflexive

(or) R is irreflexive.

The relation of perpendicularity on a set of lines in the plane

is symmetric, since if a line a is perpendicular to the line b , then b is perpendicular to a .

The relation $\leq$ on the set $\mathbb{Z}$ of integers is not symmetric, since, for example, $4 \leq 5$, $5 \not\leq 4$.

The relation of divisibility on $\mathbb{N}$ is antisymmetric, since whenever m is divisible by n and n is divisible by m then $m = n$.

Note:

Symmetry and anti symmetry are not negative of each other.

For example, the relation $R = \{(1,3), (3,1), (2,3)\}$ is neither symmetric nor anti symmetric.

whereas, the relation $S = \{(1,1), (2,2)\}$ is both symmetric and anti symmetric.

The relation of set inclusion on a collection of sets is transitive. since if $A \subseteq B$ and $B \subseteq C$, $A \subseteq C$.

Equivalence relation:

A relation R on a set A is called an equivalence relation (or) RST relation if R is reflexive, symmetric and transitive.

Ex:

Let $A = \{a, b, c\}$ and a relation

$$R = \{(a, a), (a, b), (b, b), (b, a), (a, c), (c, a), (c, c)\}$$

R is reflexive, since $(a, a), (b, b), (c, c) \in R$
for all A .

R is symmetric, since $(a, b) \in R$,
 $(b, a) \in R$,
 $(a, c) \in R, (c, a) \in R$

Again R is transitive.

Hence R is an equivalence relation.

partial ordering or partial order relation:

A relation R on a set A is called a partial ordering or partial order relation if R is reflexive, anti symmetric and transitive.

i.e. R is a partial order relation on A if it has the following three properties.

1. aRa for every $a \in A$
2. aRb and $bRa \Rightarrow a=b$
3. aRb and $bRc \Rightarrow aRc$.

Partially ordered set or poset:

A set A together with a partial order relation R is called a partially ordered set or poset.

Ex:

The greater than or equal to ($\geq$) relation is a partial ordering on the set of integers $\mathbb{Z}$,

Since 1. $a \geq a$ for every integer a ,
i.e. $\geq$ is reflexive

2. $a \geq b$ and $b \geq a \Rightarrow a = b$

i.e. $\geq$ is anti symmetric

3. $a \geq b$ and $b \geq c \Rightarrow a \geq c$

i.e. $\geq$ is transitive. Thus $(\mathbb{Z}, \geq)$ is a poset.

Partition of a set:

If S is a non-empty set, a collection of disjoint non empty subsets of S whose union is S is called a partition of S .

In other words, the collection of subsets A_i is a partition of S if and only if

(i) $A_i \neq \varnothing$, for each i

(ii) $A_i \cap A_j = \varnothing$, for $i \neq j$ and

(iii) $\bigcup_i A_i = S$, where $\bigcup_i A_i$ represents

the union of the subsets A_i for all i .

Note:

The subsets in a partition are also called blocks of the partition.

Ex:

If $S = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6\}$

then

(i) $[\{1, 3, 5\}, \{2, 4\}]$ is not a partition,

since the union of the subsets is not S , as the element 6 is missing.

(ii) $[\{1, 3\}, \{3, 5\}, \{2, 4, 6\}]$ is not a partition, since $\{1, 3\}$ and $\{3, 5\}$ are not disjoint.

(iii) $[\{1, 2, 3\}, \{4, 5\}, \{6\}]$ is a partition.